

ASK FOR MEDIATION

FSCD or PDD · Accessible fillable version · The Alberta Disability System Breakdown · September 2026

THIS IS THE ONE THAT PROTECTS THE CLOCK

Mediation is the only thing that protects your appeal deadline. For FSCD the 45 days pauses while mediation runs, then picks up where it stopped. For PDD it changes to 30 days from the day mediation ends. Asking the program to look at it again does neither.

WHAT THIS IS

Mediation is a meeting with a neutral person who does not work for the program. They help you and the program try to agree. The mediator does not decide anything and cannot make you accept anything.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

This is not a government form. Neither program has a mediation form set out in the law. The PDD rules ask only for a request “in writing”. The FSCD law does not mention a form at all. The government file, PDDFSCD10925, will not open on a phone.

IF A WORD HERE IS NEW TO YOU

We keep a plain list of what these words mean, called The Words They Use. It is free on our site.

WHAT YOU WILL NEED BEFORE YOU START

Get these together first. It is easier than stopping halfway.

- Your decision letter, or the date they told you.
- Your file number, if you have one.
- To know whether you have already filed an appeal. It changes your deadline — see page 3.
- A rough idea of what would fix it. Not a demand, just what a workable outcome looks like.

STEP 2 — WHICH PROGRAM, AND WHO YOU ARE

Which program is this about?

Tick one.

☐

FSCD — my child is under 18

☐

PDD — this is about an adult

Your full name

Your child's full name, if this is FSCD

Leave blank if this is a PDD matter.

Your address

Include your postal code.

Your phone number

A number they can reach you on.

Your email address

Leave blank if you prefer post.

File number

Leave blank if you cannot find one.

STEP 3 — THE DECISION, AND YOUR DEADLINE

When did they tell you?

Your 30 days to ask for mediation runs from here.

Have you already filed an appeal?

This changes your deadline, and it changes it in your favour. Read the box below before you tick.

☐

Yes — I have filed an appeal

☐

No — I have not filed an appeal

If you have already filed an appeal, the 30 days does not apply to you. The FSCD manual says you can ask for mediation “at any time up to the appeal hearing”. So filing the appeal first keeps this door open much longer. If you have not filed one and your 30 days is nearly up, send this now.

What did they decide?

A few sentences. What they said no to, or what they changed.

What would fix it?

What a workable outcome looks like for you. It does not have to be all or nothing.

Your signature

Typing your name is enough. If you print and post it, sign by hand too.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU SEND IT

1 They appoint a mediator.

For PDD the rules say the director SHALL appoint one. Not may — shall.

2 The mediator contacts you.

They arrange a first conversation and explain how it will work.

3 You meet.

You can bring an advocate or a support person. For FSCD the caseworker has to tell you about that right and point you to help finding one.

4 You agree, or you do not.

If you agree, that is the end of it. If you do not, your appeal is still there.

ONE THING TO ASK ABOUT FIRST, IF THIS IS PDD

Unless you agree otherwise, the PDD rules say you and the program split the mediator's costs. Ask what that is likely to be, in writing, before you agree to go ahead. The FSCD rules say nothing about cost.

WHERE TO SEND IT

FSCD: to the Disability Services office holding your child's file, or the address on the decision letter. PDD: to your PDD worker or the office named on the letter. Ask them to confirm in writing that they received it.

WHAT TO KEEP

- A copy of every page you send.
- A note of the date you sent it and how.
- Anything the mediator sends you afterwards, including the date mediation ended. That date starts your next deadline.

Where these rules come from: the FSCD Act sections 6 and 7(4); the FSCD policy manual 10.3; the PDD Services Act sections 14.1 and 15(3); and the PDD Services Regulation AR 228/2013 section 3. Read 28 September 2026.